10/10/25

The Proposal

-Anton Chekov

I Answer the following Word Meanings:-

1 Farce: A comic dramatic work with absurd situations.
Sentence The play was a complete farce.

2 Palpitation: Rapid or irregular heartbeat
Sentence His palpitation increased with excitement.

3 Implore: To beg earnestly or desperately
Sentence I implore you to forgive me.

4 Excruciating: Extremely painful or intense
Sentence The headache was excruciating today.

5 Impudence: Rude or disrespectful behaviour
Sentence His impudence shocked the teacher.

II Answer the following Reference to Context:-

1 No ---------- unfairness.

a Who is saying these lines and to whom?
Ans Natalia is saying these lines and to Lomov.

b For how long did the speaker's family have the land according to his claim?
Ans According to Lomov, his family had owned the Oxen Meadows for nearly 200 years, claiming it was passed down from his ancestors and had always legally belonged to them.

c What was the surprise the speaker is talking about?
Ans The surprise was the marriage proposal to Natalya. He visited her house intending to ask her hand in marriage, believing it was time to settle down and that she was a suitable match due to their social status and property.

d Roubles are _____
(i) Land measuring unit
(ii) Currency (✓)
(iii) Name of meadows
(iv) None of the above

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 What does Chubukov at first suspect that Lomov has come for? Is he sincere when he later says "And I've always loved you, my angel, as if you were my own son"? Find reasons for your answer from the play.

Ans At first, Chubukov suspected that Lomov had come to borrow money. He was not sincere when he told Lomov that he had always loved him and that he was like his own son. He had decided that he would not give Lomov any money if he tried borrowing from him. if he truly meant what he had said then he would not have thought of not giving him money. He said so only because Lomov had come with the proposal to marry his daughter.

Q2 Chubukov says of Natalya: "... as if she won't consent! She's in love; egad, she's like a lovesick cat..." Would you agree? Find reasons for your answer.

Ans Chubukov thought that Lomov was a good marriage prospect for his daughter. He had been waiting for this proposal. When Lomov expressed his doubt regarding Natalya's consent to the proposal, Chubukov immediately told him that she was in love with him. However this was not true... Natalya did not seem to be in love with Lomov at any point in the play. It seemed like she was more attached to her land, meadows and dogs than to Lomov. In fact, the way they kept getting into arguments about trivial matters suggests that neither Lomov nor Natalya was in the love with the other.

Q3 What is the cause of the second quarrel between Natalya and Lomov?

Ans The second quarrel begins when Lomov mentions his superior hunting dog, Guess, claiming it's better than Natalya's dog, Squeezer. Natalya strongly disagrees, insisting Squeezer is better. Their argument escalates over the dog's breed, price, and hunting abilities, turning the marriage proposal visit into another heated dispute.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 Neighbours must have a cordial relationship in order to build a strong society. Throw light on this statement taking references from the lesson 'The Proposal'.

Ans In a strong society, neighbours must maintain cordial relationships based on mutual respect and understanding. Harmony among neighbours promotes peace, cooperation, and emotional support, especially in times of need. Conflicts over trivial matters can disrupt the social fabric and lead to unnecessary tension.

Anton Chekhov's play 'The Proposal' humorously highlights how petty disputes can damage neighbourly ties. Lomov and Natalya despite being potential marriage partners and neighbours, quarrel over land ownership and dog superiority. Their constant arguments reflect how ego and pride can over shadow meaningful relationships.

The play teaches that resolving differences through dialogue and empathy is essential. If Lomov and Natalya had focused on their shared future rather than petty issues, their relationship would have strengthened. Thus, cordially among neighbours is vital for building a united and peaceful society.